Passing Tides – Linh's journey

E2–E3 • Past simple and sequencing • Teacher notes & answer key (do not print for students)

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Lesson at a glance

Level: E2–E3 (L1 extension). **Time:** about 2½ hours (whole film first, then clips). **Aim:** follow a story in two clips; tell a story in the past simple with First / Then / After that / Finally.

Film: Passing Tides (Child Migrant Stories, 18 min) – youtube.com/watch?v=3ePfMggJoFc. Linh left Vietnam by boat with her father when she was seven (1979). A British ship rescued them. They lived in camps in Singapore and on Thorney Island, then in Hackney.

Clips: 1 = 2:54–5:11 (the sea escape) 2 = 5:11–6:56 (the British ship, Singapore) 3 = 6:56–10:49 (life in England, L1 only). Subtitles on. Play each twice.

Sensitivity: the film is about a dangerous sea journey. Some learners may have made similar journeys. In Tasks 6 and 7 any journey is fine – to college this morning is a good model. Never ask learners about their journey to the UK in front of the class.

Stages

Time	Stage	What to do	Slide / WS
10	Settle in	Warmer on screen: How did you come to college today? Late arrivals start WS Task 1.	S2
10	Lead-in	Meet Linh. Map: Vietnam → Singapore → UK. Ask: How do you think she travelled?	S3
10	Key words	WS Task 1 in pairs. Check.	S4–5 / T1
20	Whole film	Read the gist questions (WS Task 2) first. Watch the whole film with subtitles. Check answers.	S6–7 / T2
5	Discussion	Pairs: How did you feel? What surprised you? What would you ask Linh?	S7
15	Clip 1	Read T/F first. Play twice. Check.	S8, S10 / T3
10	Clip 2	Read the events. Play twice. Check order.	S9, S10 / T4
15	Grammar	Regular -ed (3 sounds: /t/ /d/ /ɪd/) and irregular verbs. Sequencers: First, Then, After that, Finally.	S11–12
15	Practice	WS Task 5. E2: verb table + gaps 1–5. E3: all. Check.	S13 / T5
10	Writing	WS Task 6. Model on S14 (my journey to college).	S14 / T6
10	Speaking	WS Task 7 in pairs. Then 2–3 learners tell the class.	S14 / T7
20	Games	Hangman paragraph, then Who Wants to Be a Millionaire? in teams (buttons on S15). Kahoot if time.	S15
–	Extension	L1: clip 3 + used to / didn't use to.	S16

Differentiation

Weaker (E2): Task 5 verb table + gaps 1–5; use sentence starters. Stronger (E3): add a time phrase in each sentence (in 2019, two days later …). L1: extension.

Answer key

Task 1: 1 c 2 d 3 e 4 f 5 a 6 b

Task 2: a B b B c C d B

Task 3: a F (with her father) b T c T d F (about fifty) e F (they ran out of food) f T

Task 4: Singapore 4 men on ship 3 stayed next to ship 1 to Britain 5 women and children 2

Task 5 verbs: waited, stayed, rescued, arrived, left, got, found, threw, went, had, saw, took

Task 5 story: 1 left 2 waited 3 got 4 didn't have 5 found 6 threw 7 stayed 8 went

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Clip 1 – what Linh says (shortened, if the video fails)

"My family tried to escape a few times, but there was only enough money for two tickets, for my dad and one other. I was very frightened because we had to wade in the water, with just my head above the water, waiting to board. There were about fifty of us in this tiny boat. The boat was rocking and filling up with water … Suddenly there was this enormous British ship. We had run out of food a couple of days before. They threw down some food – cream crackers and green apples."

Games (buttons on slide 13)

Millionaire: https://atinwix.github.io/esol/games/millionaire-quiz.html?set=film-pt

Hangman paragraph:

Linh was born in Vietnam. When she was seven, she left Vietnam with her father. First, they waited in the water. Then they got on a tiny boat with about fifty people. After a few days, they had no food. Then a big British ship found them. The sailors threw down crackers and green apples. After that, they stayed in a camp in Singapore. Finally, they went to Britain and lived in Hackney.

https://atinwix.github.io/Hangman-Paragraphs-Game/?p=TGluaCB3YXMgYm9ybiBpbiBWaWV0bmFtLiBXaGVuIHNoZSB3YXMgc2V2ZW4sIHNoZSBsZWZ0IFZpZXRuYW0gd2l0aCBoZXIgZmF0aGVyLiBGaXJzdCwgdGhleSB3YWl0ZWQgaW4gdGhlIHdhdGVyLiBUaGVuIHRoZXkgZ290IG9uIGEgdGlueSBib2F0IHdpdGggYWJvdXQgZmlmdHkgcGVvcGxlLiBBZnRlciBhIGZldyBkYXlzLCB0aGV5IGhhZCBubyBmb29kLiBUaGVuIGEgYmlnIEJyaXRpc2ggc2hpcCBmb3VuZCB0aGVtLiBUaGUgc2FpbG9ycyB0aHJldyBkb3duIGNyYWNrZXJzIGFuZCBncmVlbiBhcHBsZXMuIEFmdGVyIHRoYXQsIHRoZXkgc3RheWVkIGluIGEgY2FtcCBpbiBTaW5nYXBvcmUuIEZpbmFsbHksIHRoZXkgd2VudCB0byBCcml0YWluIGFuZCBsaXZlZCBpbiBIYWNrbmV5Lg

Record of Work

Date: ____ | Teacher: Atin | Activities: Film 'Passing Tides' – key words; clip T/F and ordering events; past simple regular/irregular + First/Then/After that/Finally; writing about a journey; pair speaking; Hangman paragraph; Millionaire quiz | Notes: